



PAPUA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 24 MAY 2026 - 30 MAY 2026

DATA STATUS: MIXED SOURCES (LIVE, MANUAL & STATIC)

LATEST RECORD: 29 MAY 2026

LAST UPDATED: 30 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Papua (Indonesian West Papua) is a restricted-reporting, high-friction operating environment spanning the six provinces of the Indonesian half of New Guinea. The 7-day window holds 2 records. The current-cycle reporting points to crackdown, which is the practical concern for any footprint in the coastal cities or the resource corridors. The 30-day and 90-day context sections widen the lookback to keep highland insurgency, commemoration-date protest cycles and resource-sector exposure in view; treat them as background risk rather than live events. Reporting access in Papua is genuinely constrained, so the headline count should not be read as a measure of risk.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 24 May - 30 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 2 Limited sample	HIGHEST SEVERITY Low Worst rating in window
MOST AFFECTED AREA —	LATEST INCIDENT 29 May 2026	MAIN ISSUE TYPE Multiple issue types

SITUATION

Papua is shaped by a long-running low-intensity insurgency, recurring student and church-led protest over Jakarta's security and resource policy, heavy TNI/POLRI deployment across the highlands, and extreme geographic isolation. The current cycle's read is the 7-day window only. The 7-day window holds 2 records. Treat these as the active operational signal. Anything older than seven days sits in the 30 / 90-day context sections below and should not be read as current activity.

WHAT HAPPENED

The most recent 7-day window points to crackdown in or around the named areas. That is the active signal. Anything beyond this week — student protest cycles, highland clashes and TPNPB-OPM activity, Freeport convoy security and cross-border movement on the PNG frontier — sits in the 30 / 90-day context sections and should be read as background pattern rather than current activity.

WHAT MATTERS

Even a small record set sharpens the operating picture for Papua. Treat the named locations as where to focus access, movement and security-coordination checks, while accepting that the broader pattern needs more reporting to firm up.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Confirm Surat Jalan / travel-permit status before any movement into the highlands; access can be withdrawn at short notice during security operations.
- Plan highland and interior travel by air via Sentani, Timika, Wamena, Manokwari or Sorong; treat road movement on the Trans-Papua corridor as weather- and security-dependent.
- Hold heightened journey management around Jayapura and Manokwari campuses and government sites on commemoration dates (1 May, 1 December, 19 December) and during student protest cycles.
- For resource-sector footprints, confirm convoy security and TNI/POLRI and contracted-security coordination on the Timika–Tembagapura (Freeport) and Bintuni Bay (Tangguh LNG) corridors.
- Build in tolerance for internet shutdowns and cellular blackspots; carry HF/VHF or satellite comms for highland and interior work.
- Confirm out-of-province medevac arrangements (Makassar / Jakarta / Singapore); in-province tier-1 care is not available and highland evacuation is weather-dependent.
- Treat thin weekly reporting as restricted access, not low risk; cross-check local-language and church / NGO sources before standing down posture.

LOCATION WATCHLIST

LOCATION	NOTE	7D	30D	90D	WORST (90D)
Jayapura	Provincial capital, university protest focal point	1	8	25	HIGH
Sorong	Southwest Papua, LNG and port hub	0	4	8	MODERATE
Manokwari	West Papua capital, Tangguh corridor	0	2	4	MODERATE
Timika / Mimika (Freeport belt)	Grasberg copper-gold corridor, armed-group threat to convoys	0	4	11	EXTREME
Wamena (Baliem Valley)	Highland Papua, weather-dependent access	0	4	11	EXTREME
Nduga / Intan Jaya / Puncak	Active TPNPB-OPM operating area	0	7	18	EXTREME
Merauke	South Papua agribusiness corridor	0	2	2	LOW
Nabire	Central Papua, coastal staging point	0	0	1	LOW
PNG border districts	Keerom / Pegunungan Bintang / Boven Digoel cross-border movement	0	0	0	No records
Highlands airstrips	Sentani (DJJ), Timika (TIM), Sorong (SOQ), Manokwari (MKW), Wamena (WMX)	0	5	17	EXTREME
Trans-Papua highway corridor	Partially built, wet-season landslide closures	0	0	0	No records

30-DAY CONTEXT

Across the rolling 30-day context window Papua carries 41 records, with 39 records sitting outside the current 7-day cycle.

BACKGROUND OPERATING PICTURE

Across the rolling 90-day background window Papua carries 104 records, 63 of which sit beyond the 30-day context. Use them to size the background operating picture rather than to direct current movement decisions.

MAP



● Extreme

● High

● Moderate

● Low

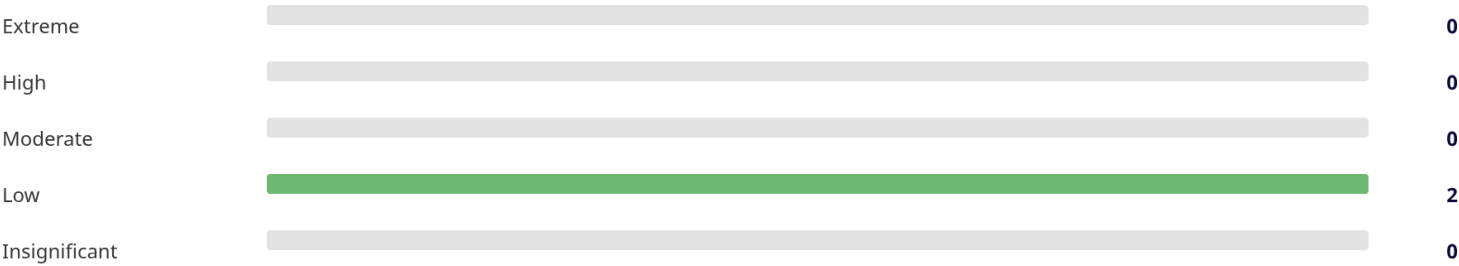
● Insignificant

Leaflet | (c) OpenStreetMap (c) CARTO

Records without coordinates are included in totals and tables but not plotted on the map. 2 of 2 records excluded from the map.

The map reflects the active reporting window — 2 7-day records. It is not the full risk picture — read it alongside the 30 / 90-day context sections above.

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION



INCIDENT BREAKDOWN BY TYPE



WATCH NEXT

- Renewed student or church-led protest out of Jayapura, Manokwari or Sorong, especially around commemoration dates.
- TNI/POLRI security operations or TPNPB-OPM clashes in Nduga, Intan Jaya, Puncak, Puncak Jaya or Yahukimo.
- Armed-group activity or convoy incidents on the Timika–Tembagapura (Freeport Grasberg) corridor.
- Labour or indigenous-rights friction around the Tangguh LNG / Bintuni Bay belt and South Papua plantation concessions.
- Highland access disruption — landslide closures on the Trans-Papua corridor, weather-grounded airstrips or operation-driven district lockdowns.
- Internet or communications shutdowns imposed in response to unrest.
- Cross-border movement or refugee flows on the Keerom / Pegunungan Bintang / Boven Digoel frontier with Papua New Guinea.

POLESTAR VIEW

Papua should be treated as a restricted-reporting, high-friction operating environment. A quiet week does not equal low risk. The current incidents point to crackdown, while the 30 / 90-day context keeps highland insurgency, protest cycles and resource-corridor exposure in view. Business users should focus on permit and movement discipline, air-first highland travel, resilient communications and clear out-of-province medevac triggers.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
29 May 2026 16:27	Protest	Papuan Women Call for Resistance Against Oppression and National Strategic Projects (PSN)	LOW
26 May 2026 01:54	Crackdown	'Threat to democracy': Indonesian filmmaker decries military crackdown on documentary	LOW

DISCLAIMER

Polestar Advisory Pte. Ltd. is an independent company registered in Singapore. The information in this report is based on open sources and is assessed as accurate at the time of writing. It is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute advice or a comprehensive assessment of all risks. No reliance should be placed on this information for decision making without further independent verification.